

Slide 1

It's May 19, 1919.

Your entire country is under attack from every direction.

And none of the higher command seems to care.

You are a simple soldier watching your homeland crumble.

So you take matters into your own hands.

-ENTER IMAGE-

You travel across the country, gathering people who are
willing to stand with you, to push back, and to
reclaim your nation.

Slide 2

Four years pass.

The war is won.

-ENTER IMAGE

Turkey is free from the grasp of the allied forces

But your work is not finished.

Even though the Ottoman Empire has fallen,
its shadow still hangs over the nation's future.

You begin transforming the state from its foundations.

Slide 3

-ENTER IMAGE-

You abolish the Sultanate and build the Republic.

You create the Parliament and the Presidency.

You secularize the nation and separate religion and state.

-ENTER IMAGE-

You replace the old alphabet with a modern one,
you raise literacy, you modernize culture, and you
change identity forever.

Slide 4

And on 9:05 AM, November 10, 1938, you leave
the country with the legacy of Mustafa Kemal Atatürk.

-ENTER IMAGE-

But the story does not end here.

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-SLOWLY ENTER IMAGES-

This was a mistake.

As time passed, the leaders that came after Atatürk got worse.

They abandoned his ideals and allowed personal power
and political interests to take precedence
over the nation.

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And this is where my monument begins.

Enter "Hayal Kırıklığı", translated "Disappointment."

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DISAPPOINTMENT is a 3.8-meter figure of a kneeling Atatürk,
cast in galvanized steel.

One hand supporting himself, the other using his
fedora to cover his face.

Not in shame, but in sorrow.

It is A symbol of sorrow and reflection,

Turning away from the Turkey's current state.

Through posture Disappointment expressed

Not hiding—refusing to witness what has gone wrong

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The monument is located at the busiest public space in
Kadıköy, directly at the exit of the ferry terminal where
thousands pass every day.

It transforms a simple transit space into a space of
confrontation and memory.

Kadıköy is a crossroads of ideologies, protests, and
expression—which makes it the perfect stage for this question:

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The viewers are everyday commuters, residents, and
citizens of Istanbul.

People from every background and belief are forced to walk
past this figure.

The monument is designed to be unavoidable.

It demands reflection and forces a conversation that Turkey
continues to avoid.

As time passes people might giving different names to this
monument, start calling him “Paşam” out of respect.

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I chose galvanized steel because it is durable, industrial,
and unbreakable. Its surface is raw and textured,
symbolizing struggle and age. Over time, this material
will weather and darken—just like the history it refers to.

The condition of the sculpture itself becomes a form of
commentary. If it is cared for and preserved, it suggests a
nation that is honoring its values and maintaining its
democratic legacy. If it is neglected, rusting, or ignored, it
reflects a government that has abandoned those ideals.

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Have we honored the legacy we inherited?

Or have we allowed it to collapse?

Slide 12

The plaque reads:

"-TURN AND READ PLAQUE-" Both in English and Turkish
so that everyone can understand what it says

The Artist has given up credit to the statue to
protect themselves

This plaque will be mounted upon a steel lectern at
about 1.3 meters, and be sized at 25x20cm.

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This sculpture does not fade into the background.
It activates public space.
It invites debate, discomfort, and even disagreement.
It reminds each passerby that the dream of the
 Republic is not guaranteed.
Because Atatürk’s story ended in 1938.
But ours continues today.

And the responsibility now belongs to us.